15. There had been periodic expulsions of FRG journalists (Spiegel and ARD) and warnings were frequently made directly to reporters. In January 1978, the Spiegel office in East Berlin was shuttered and soon after, TV reporter Luetz Lehmann was told he could not interview the prominent East German writer, Stefan Heym. At the same time, the GDR authorities used petty vengeful tactics against prominent critics such as humanist Robert Havemann who was placed under house arrest and virtually isolated from the outside world. Writers Bettina Wegener, Rolf Schneider and the aforementioned Heym were denied exit permits to travel to the West, while writer Guenter Kunert privately let it be known to American contacts that he believed that the exit permit denials were the regime's way of punishing writers who had works/ interviews appear in the West without prior official approval.

16. DPA. 18 April 1980

17. DPA. 20 February 1980

18. SED 11th plenum: Honecker on GDR economic trends and problems. 1979BERLIN07378_e

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1. Pravda . 8 May 1980

2. John O. Koehler. Stasi: Untold Story of East Germany's Secret Police . Basic Books; Revised ed. Edition. 2000.

3. Ibid

4. On 5 December, he told a special meeting in Moscow: 'We have a common boundary with the Federal Republic of Germany, and we see how the enemy tries to transpose the counter-revolutionary events in Poland in our country. Never have the broadcasting stations transmitted so much news